

Hallway

Story Context

As the sheriff walks deeper into the house, he enters a long hallway.

Paintings line the walls.

Every eye in those paintings... seems to follow him.

Scratched into the wall:

not everything is visible...

s h a d o w s w a t c h

Something is hidden... but not in plain sight.

Objective

Find the hidden flag inside the hallway image.

Files Provided

Description.txt

hallway.png

Step 1 — Read the Description

cat Description.txt

Important clues:

not everything is visible...

s h a d o w s w a t c h

Interpretation:

- “not everything is visible” → **Steganography hint**
 - Spaced text → password clue
`shadowswatch`
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Step 2 — Basic Analysis

strings hallway.png

exiftool hallway.png

Result:

- No obvious flag
- No useful metadata

Nothing visible → confirms hidden data

Step 3 — Check File Type (Important Trick)

file hallway.png

Output:

JPEG image data

Observation:

- File is named **.png**
- But actually a **JPEG**

This is intentional (misdirection)

Step 4 — Use Steganography Tool

steghide extract -sf hallway.png

Enter password:

shadowswatch

Step 5 — Extract Hidden File

After extraction:

ls

You'll find:

secret.txt

Step 6 — Get the Flag

```
cat secret.txt
```

✓ Final flag:

THM{3y3s_4r3_w4tch1ng_y0u}